# DETECT THE DWELLERS · CHAPTER DICE TEST

A paper test of one idea: **match exact numbers instead of adding them up.** Then play today's Quick Shift with the same group and compare. Tuned for **2 players**; 1–4 play the same rules.

## YOU NEED

This sheet's cards. **Standard d6s in four colours:** crew dice (2 per player), 3 in a second colour for the solo crew die and agent dice, 2 amber dice for the row, and about **18 threat dice** to set under the alarm cards. Coins for HP and to mark alarms that came back.

## SETUP

1. Each player picks an analyst. Start at **12 HP**.
2. Shuffle the six alarms face down. The Lockjaw Syndicate goes underneath.
3. Shuffle the 6 situations face down. Set the 3 conditions aside.
4. Shuffle the 8 agent cards: that's the kit deck. The crew starts with 2 agents (1 solo).

## THREAT DICE

When an alarm arrives, set threat dice **just below its card**, turned to the numbers printed along its bottom edge. Those dice are its hits. Each alarm's numbers bunch round one main number, so a double on that number goes a long way. **4 players:** add the card's **+** die (a 6). Solo to 3 players use the printed dice.

Card  +  per player past 3

1–3 players set  · 4 players 

## A FLIP

1. Pick who's on point. From the second flip on, flip a **situation** first and play it.
2. Flip the top alarm and set its dice. On point may **baseline it** (below). If anything is on the row, roll the row: every row alarm that comes back returns with its printed dice, and the two with the highest Damage hit everyone on the way in. Two or more in play: a **multi-alarm** fight.
3. Fight. When the feed is empty, the boss arrives with one last row roll and no arrival hits.

## THE ROW

Roll the **2 amber dice** and add them. A row alarm comes back if the sum is **at most its number** ("back on 2–5" comes back on 5 or less). The first time an alarm comes back, put a coin on it. It stays.

## BASELINE IT

A newly flipped alarm (never a comeback) can be baselined: set the 4 dice on its **Baseline** line too (+1 per player past 3). Beat it with them all and the agents have learned it: tuck it under an agent in the tray. That agent gains the alarm's Baseline line until it is burned or discarded. Empty tray: it waits for the next agent drawn. The alarm still goes on the row.

## A FIGHT ROUND

1. **Row.** From the second round on, roll the row first.
2. **Roll.** Everyone rolls one crew die. On point rolls two. Solo: two of your own dice plus the crew die (second colour). Each running Triage Agent rolls an agent die (second colour), set under its card. **Once a round, each player may reroll one of their own dice** before using it.
3. **Match.** A die takes out one threat die showing **exactly** its number: a  takes a  . Turn the taken die aside.
4. **Hits back.** Every alarm with dice left hits everyone who isn't blocking, for its Damage. An alarm with no dice left is beaten.

## DOUBLES

Your analyst card shows your doubles. Every other die (the solo crew die, agent dice): **only a 6**. A double **counts as two dice showing its number**: a Hunter's  takes two s, under one alarm or two. **Or** it guards: you block this round. Never both. Agent dice can't guard or hit the boss.

## AFTER A FIGHT

Beaten alarms go back on the row, **every time**: nothing removes them for good. Draw 2 agent cards (1 solo) into the tray, which holds 5. Run an agent every round, or burn it once for its big effect. A die turned by Enrichment keeps what it was: a double stays a double.

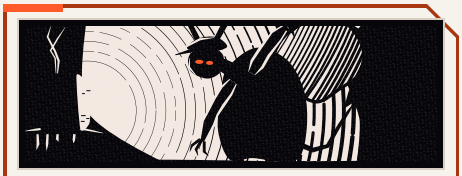
## SITUATIONS AND CONDITIONS

Most situations make you choose: stay or run, grab it or leave it. On point rolls any grab with spare dice. Conditions are cards you keep in front of you. **Rattled** and **Exposed** wear off; **Focused** waits until you use it. Nobody holds two of the same.

## WIN OR LOSE

Beat the boss and you've survived the night. Anyone at 0 HP and the shift is lost.

Prototype only. Numbers from the bot sim of 2026-10-31, exact numbers with situations and baselining (prototypes/chapter-dice/README.md). Record: who played, time, win or loss, and every rule you played wrong.



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–5

## MAILER DAEMON

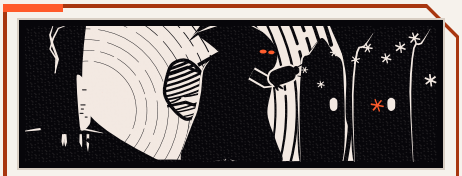
DAMAGE 1

**BEACON.** Roll the row when it arrives or comes back.

MAILER-DAEMON says your message bounced. Click here to retry. You never sent one.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
The highest-Damage alarm deals 1 less.



IDENTITY — BACK ON 2–5

## PASSWORD SPRAYER

DAMAGE 1

**PIERCING.** Blocks don't stop it.

Summer2026! tries every account in the tower, one a minute. It only needs one to work.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Once a round, reroll one more die.



CLOUD — BACK ON 2–3

## OAUTH CONSENT GRIFTER

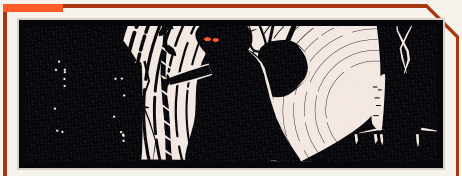
DAMAGE 3

**TARGETED.** Only on point takes its damage, doubled.

A friendly pop-up asks if this app may read all your mail. Someone's thumb is already on Accept.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
On point rolls one more die.



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–4

## LIVING-OFF-THE-LAND SCAVENGER

DAMAGE 3

**EVASIVE.** Only a double can hit it. A double of another number takes out one die.

Rundll32, mshta, certutil: every tool it runs is yours. It lives off what already grows here.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Comebacks don't hit on arrival.



NETWORK — BACK ON 2–3

## EXFIL COURIER

DAMAGE 4

**ESCALATING.** +1 Damage every round it stays up.

rclone.exe is moving 40 GB to a cloud bucket you've never seen. It's still small. For now.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
Add 1 to every row roll.



ENDPOINT — BACK ON 2–3

## ROOTKIT IMPLANT

DAMAGE 4

**REGEN.** At the end of each round, put back one die it lost.

You count the svchost.exe processes twice. One looks exactly right, and it has teeth.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

BASELINE IT
After every won fight, heal 5 split across the crew.




BOSS — ARRIVES AT 05:59

## THE LOCKJAW SYNDICATE

DAMAGE 9

**DOUBLE EXTORTION.** +2 Damage until it has lost two dice. Agent dice can't hit it.

+ PER PLAYER PAST 3

REFERENCE — EVERY DIE

## DICE

takes out a exactly

double takes anywhere

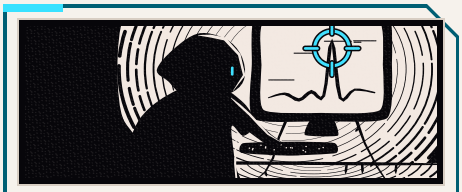
A double counts as **two** dice showing its number, **or** guards. Never both.

Your doubles are on your analyst card. Crew and agent dice: only a is a double.

**Once a round, reroll one of your own dice.**

4 players: add the card's + die.

Row: 2 amber dice; a row alarm comes back if the sum is at most its number.



ANALYST — STANDARD D6

## HUNTER

YOUR DOUBLES

A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

**Your 1s match any number on an alarm that has come back from the row.**



ANALYST STANDARD D6

## RESPONDER

YOUR DOUBLES



A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

**Once a fight, after you roll, pick an alarm: it deals no damage this round.**



ANALYST STANDARD D6

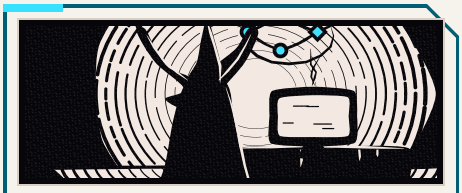
## ENGINEER

YOUR DOUBLES



A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

**Once a fight, turn one of your dice to its opposite side (1↔6, 2↔5, 3↔4). It counts as one die.**



ANALYST STANDARD D6

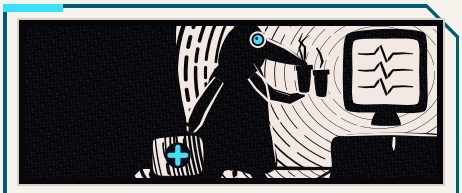
## SOARCERER

YOUR DOUBLES



A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

**The tray holds one more agent (6). The first agent you burn each fight stays in the tray.**



ANALYST STANDARD D6

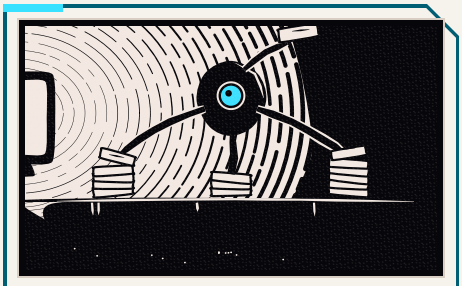
## FIXER

YOUR DOUBLES



A double counts as two dice showing its number, or guards.

**Once a fight, after you roll, turn one of your dice one up or one down.**

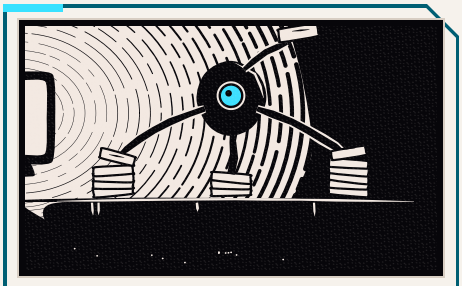


AGENT AI AGENT

## TRIAGE AGENT

RUN IT
Rolls an agent die every round.

OR BURN IT
On point rolls 3 more crew dice this round.

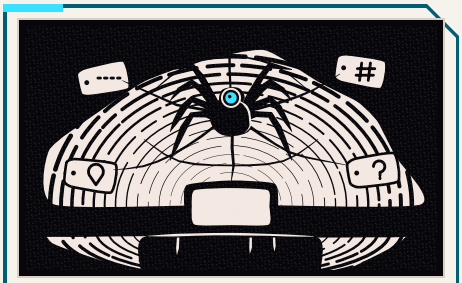


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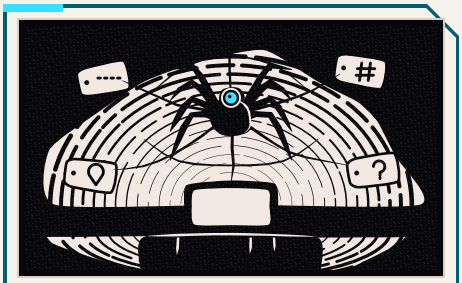


AGENT AI AGENT

## ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any number.

OR BURN IT
Every die matches anything this round.

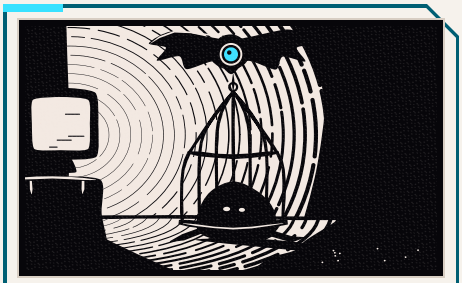


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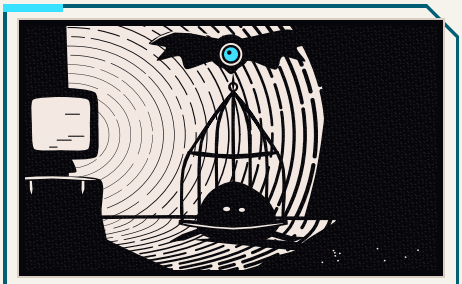


AGENT AI AGENT

## CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage alarm deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one die from every alarm (the boss keeps at least one).

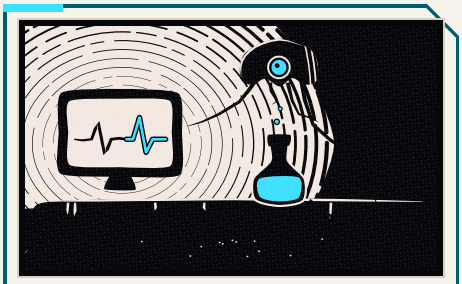


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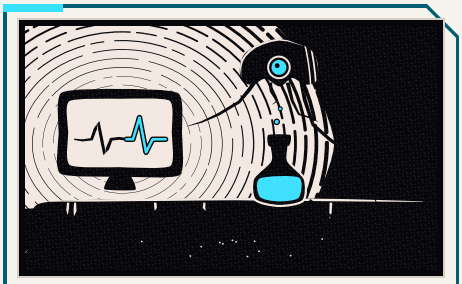


AGENT AI AGENT

## RECOVERY AGENT

**RUN IT**
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

**OR BURN IT**
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.



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STAY OR RUN SITUATION

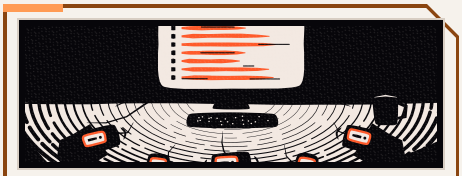
## THE BADGE THAT WASN'T

A badge swipes into the server room at 03:10. Its owner left on Friday. You're on point: find out who's holding it.

**Turn the top alarm face up, then choose.**

**HOLD THE ROOM**
On point takes Exposed. Win the fight: draw an agent.

**FALL BACK**
It hits everyone once and goes on the row unfought. Not the boss.



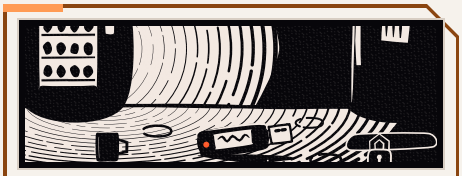
STAY OR RUN SITUATION

## PAGER STORM

Four hundred alerts land in four minutes, and every phone on the floor goes off. Everyone is awake now.

**RIDE IT OUT**
Everyone loses 2 HP.

**MUTE IT**
The next alarm sets one more threat die: a ⚅.



GRAB SITUATION

## THE JANITOR'S USB

A USB stick sits on the break-room table, labelled SALARIES 2026. Three people have already plugged it in.

**GRAB IT**
On point rolls 3 dice. Any pair: draw 2 agents and take Focused. No pair: take Rattled.

**LEAVE IT**
Nothing happens.



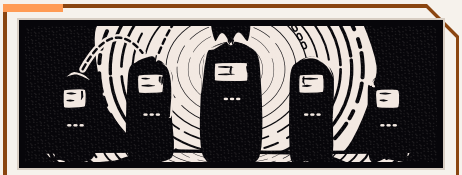
GRAB SITUATION

## DARK WEB CHATTER

Your company's name turns up on a forum at 02:30, next to a price. Someone is selling a way in.

**DIG IN**
On point picks 1–4 dice and rolls them. Any ⚅: draw 2 agents. None: lose 1 HP per die.

**LET IT GO**
Nothing happens.

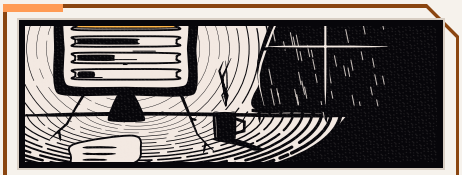


EVENT SITUATION

## LATERAL WHISPERS

Logons hop from host to host, one every ninety seconds. Something you beat is looking for a way back in.

**Roll the row now. Anything that comes back hits on arrival and joins the next fight.**



CHOICE SITUATION

## PATCH TUESDAY

The patches deploy and the tower goes quiet. You get a window. Use it.

**TAKE A BREATHER**
Everyone heals 2 HP.

**RAID THE SUPPLY CLOSET**
Draw an agent.

CONDITION BAD

## RATTLED

Your next roll has no doubles. Then discard this.

CONDITION BAD

## EXPOSED

Your next fight: each round anything hits you, take 1 more. Discard this after the fight.

CONDITION KEEP IT

## FOCUSED

Once, after you roll, turn one of your dice to any number. Then discard this.